

A smaller hole

The hole in the ozone layer seems to be slowly shrinking as scientists have finally observed the second-smallest hole they've seen in 20 years

Something's fishy here

A new batch of crew arrived at the ISS this month, bringing with them 32 extra members, Japanese medaka fish for the aquarium

Space Age

the hotel are first greeted by the sight of the venerable Lunar Descent module, and the old American flag (replanted now that the moon was colonized). The footsteps of the first astronauts are there for everyone to see as well and are covered in foot-high glass so people can actually walk the same path as Neil Armstrong and Buzz Aldrin. The hotel, being such a large structure, is prone to meteorite impacts and there have been incidents in the past when the debris from passing asteroids has peppered the dome and once, almost resulted in a catastrophic failure of the structure. The dome has since been upgraded with the state of the art, ArcLite defense grid that consists of no less than 7 Arc lite mkII radars and 6, independently controlled OverArc cannons capable of vapourising a 40km diameter asteroid at a distance of 300 kms using tactical nukes and pulsed lasers. There are many smaller

guns and cannons fitted to the system for some more close range defense. Also, the few feet of lunar dust that cover the dome are quite capable of absorbing the impact of any minor meteorite that might escape.

Day 1: Lunar tour

After breakfast, guests will be taken on a guided tour of the lunar colony and the infrastructure associated with it. Our first stop, being the closest, will be a visit to the lunar museum, where you will be shown some of the primitive gear used by the astronauts at the time of the early Apollo missions, including primitive seismographs and the original Hasselblad camera that was used to take pictures of the moon.

After the tour, all guests will be equipped with space suits, tracking beacons and wireless cameras (for your safety) and will then be taken to the LunaCorp's mining facilities just 90kms

from the Hotel. The journey will take place via maglev transport and will be accomplished in under 15 minutes. Lunch will be served at the LunaCorp mess and we will be given a tour of the facilities. After the trip, you will be taken back to the hotel where you will be free for the rest of the day.

LunaCorp Mining facility

This sprawling facility covers over a million square miles and is in fact, the largest "farm" in the solar system, and is managed by a staff of barely 2,000 employees. These employees, mainly maintenance engineers, are responsible for the care of over 8,000 harvesters. These harvesters are not very different from the combine-harvesters we used to use for farming on Earth. Their primary job is to mine out the surface of the moon and extract Helium 3 from the regolith on the surface. These

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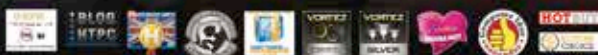


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